



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Gabriel Classical Academy
School Website: <https://stgclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Gabriel Classical Academy (SGCA) presents a robust classical-Catholic educational model anchored in Catholic doctrine, liturgical life, and a clearly articulated Trivium-based curriculum. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize a dual commitment to faith and classical liberal arts, with explicit references to Catholic identity, daily Mass, sacraments, and a formal mission that foregrounds faith, reason, and virtue. The school's curriculum is organized around grammar, logic, and rhetoric stages, with attention to Great Books-adjacent texts, history study integrated across the curriculum, and a strong emphasis on memory work, chanting, and liturgical life as part of pedagogy. Family partnership and servant leadership in the community are also foregrounded, including a Family Service Investment Fee and explicit parent involvement opportunities.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly articulated through a Catholic identity, token statements of faith, daily Mass, liturgical life, and catechetical formation. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Transcendental Truth-Realism, Theology, Liturgical Practice, and Sacramental worldview.
- The School Purpose and Goal centers on formation of virtue and wisdom, not vocational preparation alone, with explicit language about faith, reason, virtue, and human flourishing.
- Curriculum is explicitly framed around liberal arts-informed structures (grammar-logic-rhetoric), integration of history across disciplines, Great Books/primary-source orientation, and an emphasis on awe and wonder.
- Pedagogy combines contemplative elements (Scholé), memory-based practices, and Socratic/seminar-style discourse at the upper levels, including rhetoric training and public speaking.
- Faculty is positioned as mentors and living curriculum, with emphasis on character formation and exemplary models.
- Parents & Community are positioned as partners in formation, with a formal Family Service Investment Fee, open tours, and parent engagement opportunities.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents a Catholic identity as its core educational frame, describing itself as an educational community dedicated to the Catholic Church and the life of Christ, with daily Mass and sacraments as part of student life (Statement of Faith; daily Mass references).
- Public materials emphasize liturgical life, sacred worship, catechesis, and sacramental life as integral to education (Liturgical/Communal Practices references; Educational Philosophy pages) .
- The mission and philosophy articulate truth, faith, reason, and virtue as guiding anchors, with explicit Catholic intellectual traditions, sacred scripture, and Magisterium alignment described in educational philosophy materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis



- Positive keywords present: Catholic, theology, liturgy/mass, sacramental, sacred, sacred scripture, catechesis, Magisterium, faith, reason, virtue, theological foundations, worship, Mass, sacred music.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit secular-neutral or relativistic signals detected in the public-facing materials reviewed).

Why this rating

- The school's public-facing materials foreground a transcendental, theologically grounded, and liturgically anchored foundation, consistent with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of secular-neutral or relativistic signals and the explicit Catholic identity support a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations: Catholic identity, daily Mass, and liturgical life are evidenced through the Saint Gabriel Catholic Classical Academy materials (e.g., Statement of Faith, daily Mass references) . The Catholic educational philosophy and faith-informed formation content are described in mission/educational philosophy pages .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials articulate formation as the aim, emphasizing virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing rather than mere workforce preparation. The mission states formation through a Catholic liberal arts framework focused on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; the school describes forming joyful, virtuous disciples of Christ (Mission; Our Story) .
- Materials emphasize that education is formation over mere information and that the mind can know transcendent realities (education grounded in faith, reason, virtue; Great Conversation/Western tradition language appears via curriculum references) .
- Great Books/Western intellectual tradition and the goal of forming human excellence are reflected in curriculum pages and admissions statements that describe living through virtue, wisdom, and the classical tradition (Our Story; Curriculum pages) .

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, scholé, contemplation, great conversation, human excellence, soul craft.
- Negative keywords present: none of the explicit “workforce preparation” or overly vocational signals; some language around tuition and enrollment mechanics exists but not as a substitute for formation goals.

Why this rating

- The program's aims center on character formation, intellectual formation, and the pursuit of transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty), which aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for School Purpose and Goal. The lack of explicit emphasis on workforce-prep signals (e.g., 21st-century-skills rhetoric) supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission statements and Our Story emphasize formation and Catholic liberal arts framing . The Great Conversation/formation language is reflected in curriculum-oriented materials and our narrative of classical aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is explicitly structured around grammar-logic-rhetoric (Grammar Stage, Logic Stage, Rhetoric Stage), indicating the Seven Liberal Arts framework, with explicit emphasis on classics and primary sources (Great Books orientation; canonical texts cited in curriculum materials) .

- History is integrated across the curriculum rather than treated as social studies alone; students study history throughout the curriculum and read classic texts (e.g., *The Yearling*, *The Merchant of Venice*, *The Screwtape Letters*) in fourth grade and related materials in upper grades; Latin/Greek/cambridge and other classical texts are used (Curriculum pages; Fourth Grade Curriculum; 6th-Grade Academic Curriculum) ,.
- Great Books and the “Great Conversation” are referenced in public-facing materials (e.g., our curriculum references, primary-source texts, and textual selections) and the K-8th curriculum pages highlight classical texts and canonical authors; there is explicit emphasis on reading and discussing classic works and shaping students’ minds through foundational texts (Curriculum pages; Fourth Grade Curriculum; K-8 Curriculum page) ,.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; primary sources; Western civilization; Latin/Greek; sacred tradition; history integrated; memorization; sacred music; memory work; hymnody.
- Negative keywords: absence of social-studies-as-primary-lens; no heavy emphasis on purely project-based, non-cultural-heritage approaches; no anti-tradition language. The public materials show strong canonical and historical-culture orientation rather than social-justice-centric or postmodern framings that might signaling non-classical approaches.

Why this rating

- SGCA’s curriculum demonstrates classic elements (grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books/primary sources, integrated history, sacred tradition, memorization and chant, classical languages) and aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Curriculum. The inclusion of canonical texts and primary sources supports a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Citations: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages and Great Books orientation are described across the site (Grammar Stage; Logic Stage; Rhetoric Stage) ,. Great Books/primary sources and canonical authors appear in Fourth Grade Curriculum and curriculum pages ,.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The pedagogy foregrounds Scholé/restful learning and contemplative pacing in parts of the program, as described in “Pedagogical Methods” resources and the Lexicon, with lower grades emphasizing singing/memory to deepen memory and delight (Singing/chanting; memory work; restfulness) ,.
- Upper grades employ Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, as described in the Rhetoric Stage and related curriculum pages (Socratic dialogue, discourse, public speaking; rhetorical training) ,.
- Public materials explicitly reference the use of memory work, recitation, and catechesis integrated with liturgical practices; there is also a clear emphasis on upper-grade rhetoric and speech (Rhetoric Stage, etc.) ,.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, seminar, scholé, contemplation, restfulness, memorization/recitation, chanting, liturgical integration, rhetoric, public speaking, masterful texts in rhetoric.
- Negative keywords: The public materials do not reflect a strong emphasis on purely project-based learning, experiential learning as the sole mode; no dominant “constructivist-only” approach is advertised.

Why this rating

- SGCA’s pedagogy tracks the classical spectrum: contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) alongside Socratic/seminal discourse at the higher levels, plus explicit memory-work and liturgical integration.

This combination aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Pedagogy and Teaching Methods, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Pedagogical methods and the existence of Scholé/restful learning, memorization, and Socratic/rhetoric instruction are shown across the site (Pedagogical Methods; Rhetoric Stage; Preschool/Song-chant memory references) ,.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and knowledge; the living curriculum concept and a faculty-as-core-community are emphasized in classical-education lexicon and SGCA materials (Living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as friends) ,.
- The school highlights a culture of mentorship, collegiality, and professional formation among teachers; a published “Faculty & Staff” section exists, with emphasis on teachers modeling virtue and wisdom (Faculty & Staff reference).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: masters/mentors, virtuous teachers, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship, virtue, wisdom, character formation.
- Negative keywords: No explicit signals of “certification-driven” or less-classical teacher frames; no negative cues appear in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials explicitly align with the classical expectation that teachers are mentors, living exemplars, and the core of the school’s formation, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Faculty and staff pages plus “educational philosophy” language emphasize the teacher as living curriculum and moral exemplar ,.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly partners with families, positions parents as co-educators, and promotes parent formation through book studies and gatherings; there is a dedicated Family Service Investment Fee that ties family involvement to tuition credit, signaling a community-of-learners approach rather than a consumer model ,.
- The public materials encourage visits, admissions events, tours, and various ways for parents to engage with the school; there is a structured admissions/events page emphasizing parental involvement and regular communications ,.
- The “Catholic Family/Community” ethos is reinforced through mission statements, faith formation activities, and the emphasis on partnership with families in the educational mission (Family Service Investment Fee; Mission; Our Story) ,.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school partnership, family service investment, open campus, tour-friendly, parental involvement.
- Negative signals: None clearly evident in the public materials; the materials signal strong parental engagement rather than consumer-centric language.

Why this rating

- SGCA’s materials emphasize parent partnership, parental formation, and open involvement, aligning with Positive Keywords for Parents & Community. The explicit Family Service Investment model and opportunities for parental engagement reinforce a CLASSICAL evaluation.

Citations: Family Service Investment Page and admissions/events materials show explicit parent involvement and partnership language „

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, SGCA demonstrates a consistently Classical orientation across all six categories, with explicit Catholic identity, formation-focused aims, a grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum, contemplative and Socratic pedagogy, teacher-mentors as central to the living curriculum, and a robust partnerships-with-parents community. The aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable: No category is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required to reach a full CLASSICAL standing across the six categories.

ABSTRACT

St Gabriel Classical Academy presents a cohesive CLASSICAL profile as evidenced by Catholic identity and liturgical practice, formation-centered aims (virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty), a Trivium-based curriculum with Great Books/primary texts, a pedagogical mix of Scholé, memorization, and Socratic/seminar-based discourse, a living-curriculum faculty model, and a strong parent-community partnership. The school's public materials consistently map onto the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework, with minimal to no negative signals. Across all six categories, SGCA aligns closely with classical education criteria, yielding a CLASSICAL classification and a strong overall alignment with classical educational objectives.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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